

The Un-openable Book

I had never ever seen anything so beautiful. It was my birthday and my grandma had brought me this lovely gift. After the party, my best friend, Mini, and I had **eagerly** but carefully **unwrapped** the silvery packet and found the beautiful blue book in there.

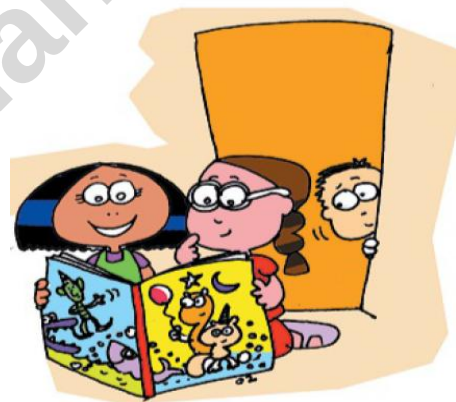
Velvety to touch and soft sky blue in colour, it was just the right size to be carried around. There were stories of all kinds in it — animal stories, stories of **fairies** and naughty children — all with beautiful pictures. I just couldn't wait to start reading the book.



After **seeing** Mini **off**, I went straight for the book but just as I was opening it, my **pesky** brother, Tony, **toddled in**.

"Let me see! Let me see!" he **lisp**ed.

As if I would do that! I **shut** the book and **put** it **on** the highest **shelf** where he couldn't reach it. He started crying but I didn't care. It was MY book! And I didn't like sharing MY things. I never let him come near my toys either!



After he was in bed I **settled** comfortably **in** my bed and took the book out. But try as I would the book wouldn't open! It was as if its pages were stuck with some super-glue. I couldn't read a single story!

The very next morning I **rushed to** mum, crying, "Mummy, I can't open this book!"

"What?" asked mum surprised, "Let me see!"

She took the book and opened it easily.

"What are you complaining about?" she smiled at me, "It opens as easily as any other book! Here, take it and run along now!"

I tried to open it at least a hundred times when I was alone but the book refused to open.



Then granny called up, "So, Tinni, how did you like your birthday present?"

"Did you mean the book, Granny?" I **burst out**. "I haven't been able to open it, let alone read any story!"

"Oh! Oh!" granny said. "Then you couldn't have read the instructions carefully!"

"Instructions?" I said, surprised, "Books don't have any..."

"Instructions, Granny! They are not like games!"

"Oh, but this one has!" granny said. "Just one instruction, but an important one."

I ran back to my room and looked carefully for the instructions on the cover. There wasn't any.

I turned the book over, found nothing there either. And then I saw at the very bottom something written in very small letters. It was just one word:

'SHARE'!

Share? What kind of instruction was that?

Then I remembered that every time the book had opened, there was always someone with me. The first time Mini had been with me, then when mum opened it, I was with her!

I noticed a small movement near the door.
It was Tony, standing there and smiling at me.

Would the book open if I shared it with him?

"Come here, Tony," I called him. "Shall I read you a story?"

"YES!" he **bounded up** to me like an excited puppy.

We **sat down** on the floor with the book between us. I was **wondering** whether it would open or not. **Hesitatingly** I lifted the cover and —
WOW! It opened as easily as anything!

Excitedly we flipped over the pages and I read my little brother one story after another... for hours and hours!

It has become a routine now. Every evening Tony and I sit together and I read out stories to him. And I guess I'm good, because I've **managed to** teach him to read a bit too!

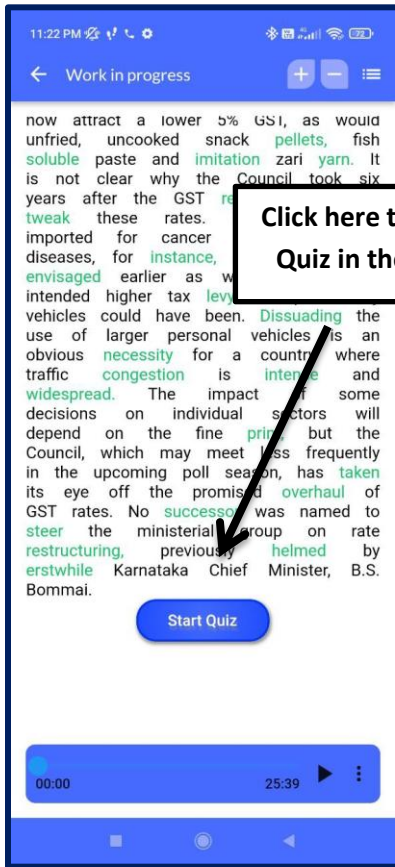
And to tell you the **absolute** truth —
it is much, much, much more fun to read with him!



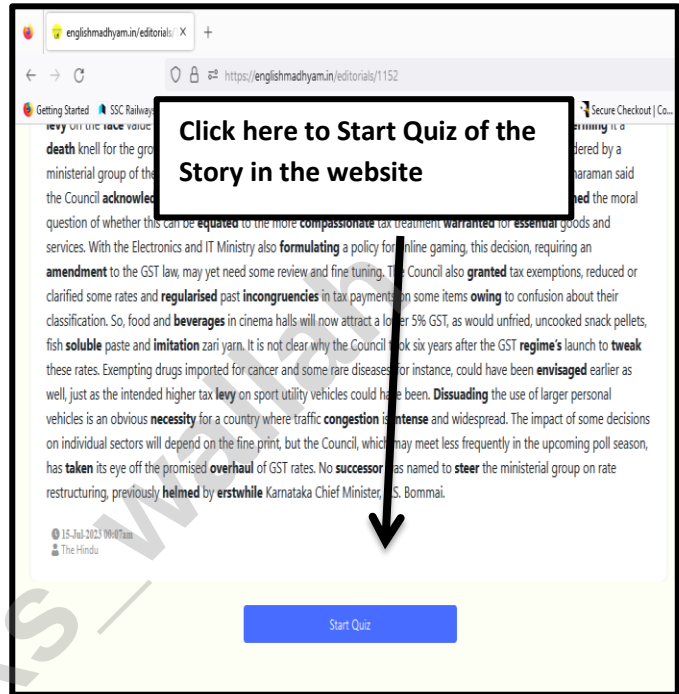
Vocabulary

1. **Eagerly** (adverb) – excitedly, keenly, enthusiastically, impatiently, ardently – उत्सुकता से
2. **Unwrap** (verb) – open, uncover, expose, peel, unpack – खोलना
3. **Velvety** (adjective) – soft, smooth, silky, plush, gentle – मखमली
4. **Fairy** (noun) – sprite, elf, pixie, enchantress, magical being – परी
5. **See off** (phrasal verb) – bid farewell, escort, accompany, wave goodbye, send away – विदा करना
6. **Pesky** (adjective) – annoying, troublesome, irritating, bothersome, nagging – परेशान करने वाला
7. **Toddle in** (phrasal verb) – walk in slowly, wander in, totter in, stroll in, enter unsteadily – लहराते हुए अंदर आना
8. **Lisp** (verb) – mispronounce, slur, speak unclearly, babble, murmur – तोतलाना
9. **Shut** (verb) – close, seal, block, fasten, snap – बंद करना
10. **Put on** (phrasal verb) – place, keep, set, rest, position – रखना
11. **Shelf** (noun) – ledge, rack, bracket, board, platform – शेल्फ / तख्ती
12. **Settle** (in) (verb) – relax, get comfortable, sink in, nestle, ease in – आराम से बैठना
13. **Rush** (to) (verb) – hurry, dash, run, race, speed – दौड़ना
14. **Burst out** (phrasal verb) – exclaim, cry out, shout, blurt, erupt – फूट पड़ना (कहने या रोने में)
15. **Bound up** (phrasal verb) – jump, leap, hop, spring, pounce – उछलते हुए आना
16. **Sit down** (phrasal verb) – take a seat, rest, perch, relax, settle – बैठना
17. **Wonder** (verb) – ponder, think, question, contemplate, speculate – आश्चर्य करना / विचार करना
18. **Hesitatingly** (adverb) – reluctantly, uncertainly, unsurely, timidly, cautiously – हिचकिचाते हुए
19. **Manage** (to) (verb) – succeed, accomplish, handle, achieve, carry out – सफल होना
20. **Absolute** (adjective) – complete, total, pure, utter, unqualified – पूर्ण / सम्पूर्ण

Practice Exercise



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